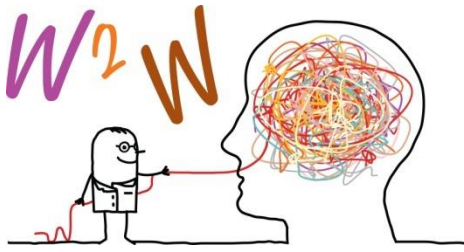


Working
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Working Towards Wellbeing

Cancer Support and Recovery

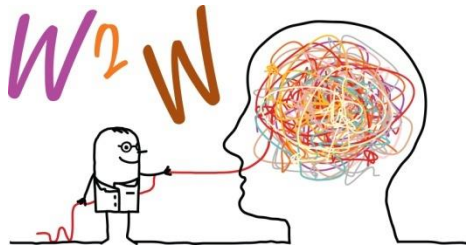
Dr Julie Denning CPsychol



What next.....?

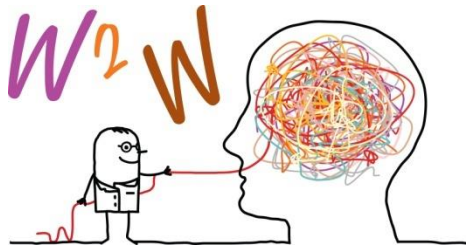
- So, you have:
 - Experienced symptoms
 - Been given a diagnosis
 - Been operated on
 - Been given adjunct therapies
 - Been given on-going medication to take
 - Been given the all clear and discharged....

BUT you still have the following



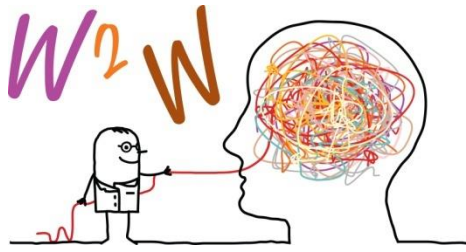
Impact of Cancer

- Pain
- Fatigue/loss of energy/limited stamina
- Body image issues
- Financial issues
- Health system -> Well system transition issues
- New 'normal' thinking
- Long term medication to manage
- Side effects of long term medication
- Work related issues



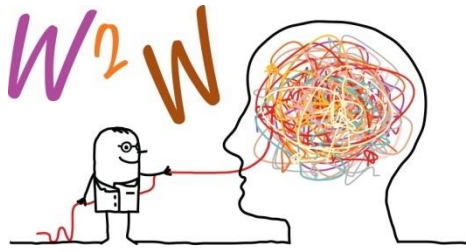
Support post treatment

- Many of the people we work with describe a 'black hole' post treatment
- Two issues:
 - 1) No longer in the Health System
 - 2) Don't feel well enough to go back into the 'Well System'



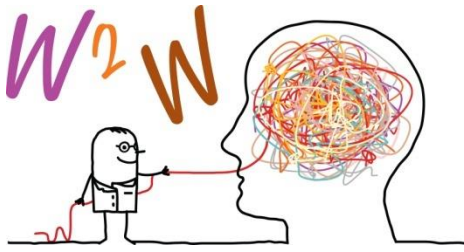
Transition service required

- People need support to take them from a patient back to a person
- Providing support during this transition can help people to get back on their feet and into their lives again



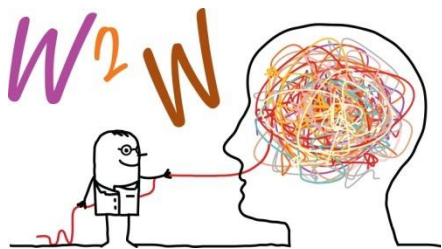
Outside vs inside

- On the outside people look well and others remark on it
- On the inside there are still issues rumbling on:
 - Physically
 - 'I am so tired'
 - 'I am in pain'
 - 'I look different'
 - Mentally -
 - Anxiety 'will the cancer come back'
 - Depression 'I will never be my old self again'



Types of support needed

- Physically
 - Physiotherapy
 - Exercise support
- Mentally
 - Problem solving support
 - Psychotherapy
- Vocationally
 - Phased return planning
 - Obstacles to return to work



The role of work in recovery



**WE ARE
MACMILLAN.**
CANCER SUPPORT

DH Department
of Health

**Thinking positively
about work**
Delivering work support
and vocational rehabilitation
for people with cancer

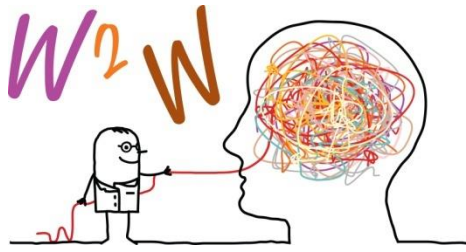
Evaluation of the National
Initiative (NCSI)
Vocational

Work and cancer series

UCL
**WORK
IT OUT**

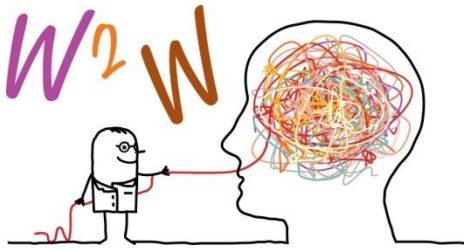
Essential questions to ask about work and cancer

**WE ARE
MACMILLAN.**
CANCER SUPPORT



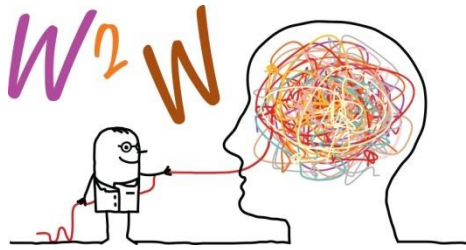
The link between work and health

- Work plays an important role in people's lives
- It provides: structure, social support, financial remuneration, a sense of self, a sense of normalcy, a purpose (Waddell and Burton 2006, Coats and Lehti 2008)
- Dame Carol Black's review (2008) suggested that work is good for health and worklessness leads to poorer health
- Approx 6 million people in the UK are in work and managing a long term health problem (Improving health and work: changing lives 2008)



Evidence: cancer and work

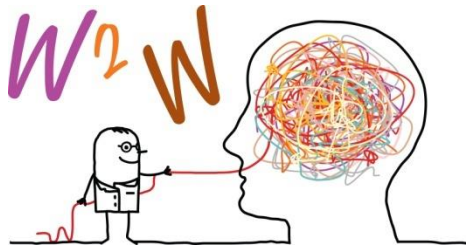
- More working age cancer patients are surviving the disease but vocational rehabilitation needs are not high on anyone's agenda ('Returning to Work: Cancer and vocational rehab, Macmillan 2008)
- It is helpful for people to start thinking about a return to work right from the beginning of their cancer journey (Returning to work, 2008) but few services are available
- All people working or with potential to work should be offered work support and advice (Macmillan/DOH, 2012)
- Work plays an important role in people's lives providing: structure, social support, financial remuneration, a sense of self, a sense of normalcy, a purpose (Waddell and Burton 2006, Coats and Lehki 2008)



Barriers to return to work

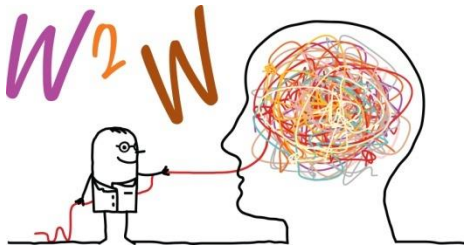
- Health terms: cancer site, stage and prognosis, treatment and co-morbidities (Feuerstien et al 2010), fatigue, chronic pain
- Psychosocial issues: age, education, mood, motivation to work (Rasmussen and Elverdam 2008), fear of recurrence, body image concerns, 'chemo brain'
- Work related issues: physical demands of the job, employer flexibility about RTW
- Health care teams: limited provision of information regarding RTW to patients (Main et al 2005), limited confidence to be able to deal with work related issues (Bains et al 2011)

(*National Cancer Survivorship Initiative literature)



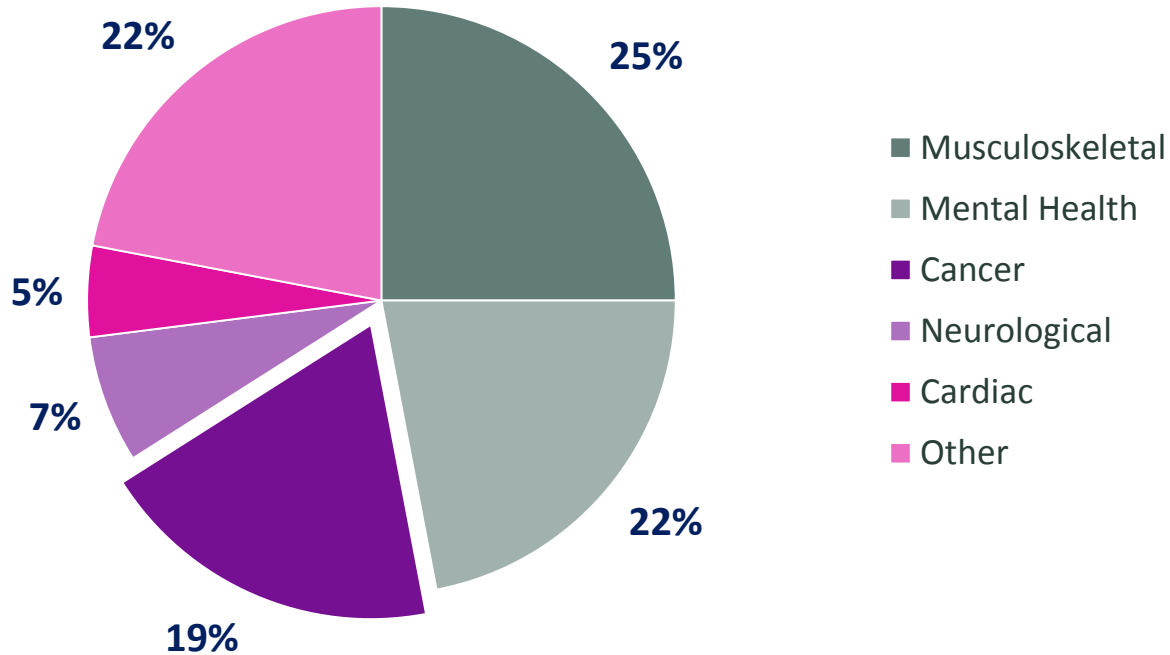
What do people living with Cancer say?

- <http://www.macmillan.org.uk/Cancerinformation/Livingwithandaftercancer/Workandcancer/Supportforemployees/SupportForEmployees.aspx>

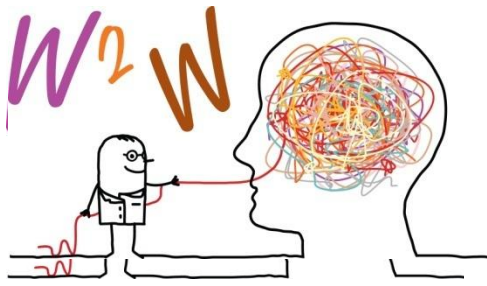


What impact is cancer having on long term absence in income protection?

Cause of new IP claims 2011 (Individual policies)*



Absence is usually long term by the time of claim

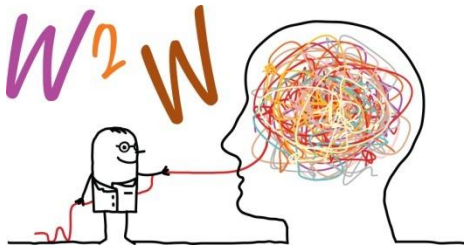


Working
towards
Wellbeing

The Cancer Work Support Service

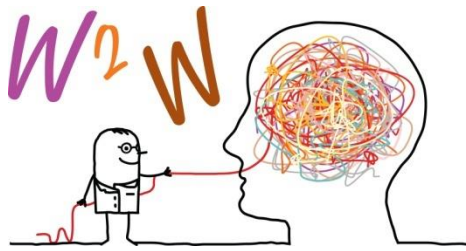
Partnership between
Working Towards Wellbeing and Swiss Re

SWISS RE
150
YEARS



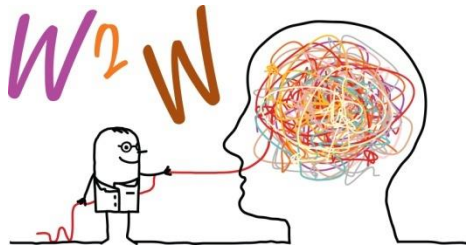
What is The Cancer Work Support Service?

- Provides support and interventions aimed at helping people who are living with cancer to stay in work or return to work
- Provides transition support from patient to person
- Offers **early** access to a vocational case manager :
 - who listens and understands the impact of their condition on their work
 - works out with the person what its best to do in their particular circumstances
 - offers information and advice to support the individual to remain in or return to work
 - refers for more specialised interventions as needed
 - facilitates communication between the person, their employer, health teams and insurer



A stepped care model for cancer

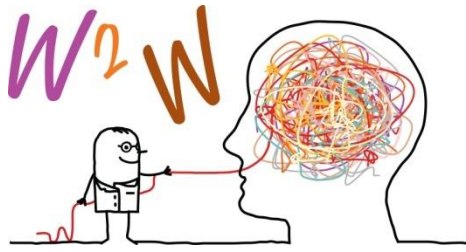




Specialist interventions

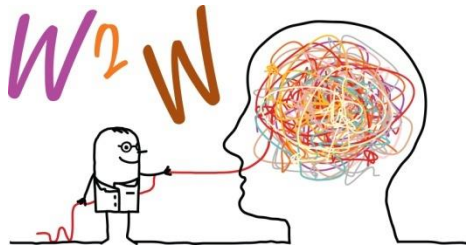
- Structured Exercise Programmes (stepped)
- Physiotherapy
- Cognitive Behavioural Therapy (CBT)
- Worksite Assessments (incl Ergonomic assessments)
- Workplace conferences (telephonic or face to face)





Lessons learned

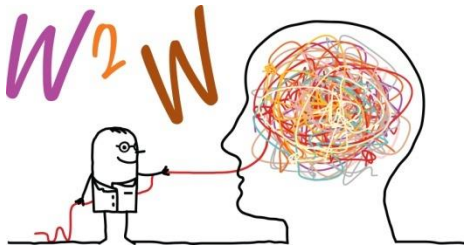
- ✓ Feedback is overwhelmingly positive for the service
- ✓ People respond well to offer of help – even if early
- ✓ Stepped care model requires flexibility
- ✓ Individualised approach is needed
- ✓ There are many barriers faced by cancer survivors in returning to work but these can be overcome with support
- ✓ Workplace accommodations are key



Mind the gap

- ✓ Role needed to bridging the gap between NHS provision and the workplace
- ✓ Link in with treating team very important
- ✓ Importance of support in adjusting to and managing cancer as a chronic illness





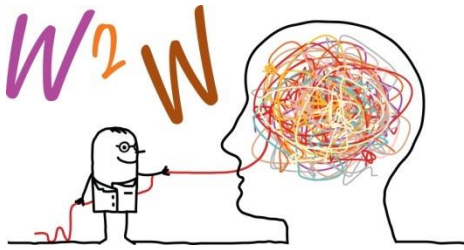
Case studies – Beth

- 45 year old office worker diagnosed with breast cancer and first absent from work in July 2012 and referred to CWSS November 2012
- Main cancer symptoms: pain from surgery, fatigue, 'guarding' her arm
- Challenges to returning to work: managing her fatigue, meeting demanding targets, colleagues' reactions
- Wishes in terms of return to work: to return as soon as possible
- Support provided by CWSS: L2 coaching, phased return to work, liaising with line manager in conference calls, physiotherapy
- Outcome = successfully supported to return to work in January 2013 after a 6 month absence, Full RTW 5 months
- Total time working with CWSS: 33 weeks which included in work support

Outcome: at work on full duties.

Total Cost £1325

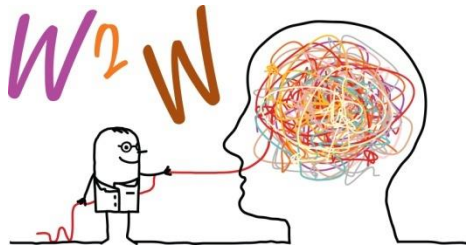
'This service helped me through a very difficult time in my life. With the support of my case manager, I was able to fully return to work and this service is invaluable'



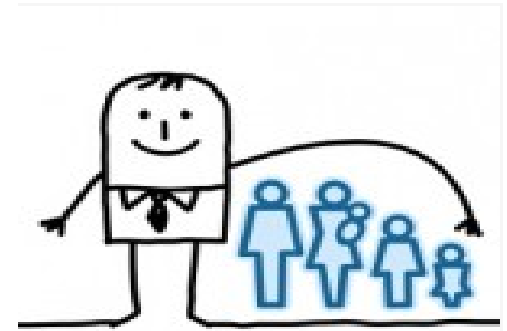
Case studies -Madge

- Madge was diagnosed with bowel cancer in March 2013. She had chemotherapy and radiotherapy to reduce the tumour in her bowel followed by surgery to remove it.
- She reported difficulty sitting down for long periods of time due to pain, feeling fatigue as a result of her body not up-taking nutrients from the food she eats
- She found it difficult to talk about what has happened to her as it was a reminder that she couldn't do the things that she used to be able to do. She had been off work since August 2013
- Madge was referred into the service at Level 2 in September 2013 and commenced a graded return to work in mid October 2013.
- She received Level 2 coaching support to help her develop her return to work plans.
- She was offered the option of CBT to help with her mood but declined at the time
- Madge was reviewed over a 6 month period. She received a total of 4 hours and 15 minutes of coaching support over 9 sessions to return to and remain in work and to improve her overall functioning.
- **Outcome: at work on full duties. Total Cost £585**

'I felt at ease immediately by talking to Julie who always gave good sound advice'



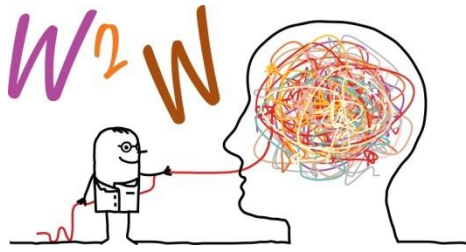
Feedback



"Even as a confident person who enjoyed my job , I felt anxious about returning to work after a long period of time off and a life changing illness. The phased return programme , along with the physio sessions and counselling helped me return to work smoothly and confidently. THANK YOU !"

"Good to have impartial advice"

"Thank you for all your time. It's been cathartic to talk. I haven't even talked to my family about these things."



Questions?

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